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CS 418
September 12, 2024

The name of my proposed project is "The Effects and Consequences of Technology in Elementary School Classrooms". This project will look into the positive or negative effect of elementary schools implementing the use of technology such as iPads and laptops to aid their lessons. Below is the information of my group mates and myself.

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The "big idea" is to investigate whether or not the implementation of technology in early schooling is beneficial for students. The problem that I want to solve is to find the detriment in what is affecting the learning abilities of students. Is it better for students to have access to iPads/laptops to facilitate and further their education, or is it actually causing more distractions in the classroom setting? Others should care about this problem because children deserve a proper education in early childhood to prepare them for adulthood. I chose this topic because I believe my generation was one of the last to go through elementary school without having access to iPads and laptops, so I'm curious to see if the addition of these in classrooms actually has a benefit.

The data that I plan to use includes standardized testing conducted on elementary school students, such as the Illinois Assessment of Readiness (IAR). We can also utilize SAT results for long term effects. These data sets will be split into elementary schools that use technology in classrooms and those that do not. There is some data readily available online such as the Illinois State Board of Education Report Card, which contains data on how districts and schools are performing academically. As a group, we would have to put in effort in collecting data on which schools are actively using technology in their classrooms. We can probably get this information in a reasonable amount of time, depending on how collaborative school staff are. In terms of size, we should aim at collecting data from a minimum of 5 schools, relating to test scores and student engagement.

As for approaching the problem, we must find a trend relating to academic success and the involvement of technology. If it is found that classrooms with technology lead to higher testing scores then the classrooms should be continuing to use technology. If the opposite is found, then schools should consider removing technology, or figuring out a better way to use technology. The scope of the project should be limited to a small number of schools due to time constraints, but next steps should be to engage with other elementary schools within the state, or even on a national level to determine how we can better prepare the future generation of students. The end result should be a clear suggestion for schools of whether or not technology is beneficial for early-age students. The techniques used to analyze the data will include created bar graphs to compare testing results within the different schools and technology approaches. Our system should be static to ensure that the main idea is shown. Ideally, our Progress report will have the data we have collected from the several elementary schools we have reached out to, as well as a data pool with relevant information.